Did we lose any territory? That is a moot point, in the absence of any demarcated boundary.

Nevertheless, I was getting quite perturbed by these almost daily reports of face-offs, mostly turning violent, particularly the one of 18/19 May, which had not only resulted in some injuries but also the loss of controlled stores, damage of radio sets and so on. I forthwith decided to make an unscheduled visit to Leh to meet the Commanders on ground and get a feel of the situation. The visit did not leave me with a favourable impression. The Commanders were trying to reason why they had been underprepared. Once is fine, but to be underprepared on the second and subsequent occasions was just not acceptable. It seemed to me that there was a lack of information-sharing within the formation and attempts to underplay the situation. I made it clear in no uncertain terms that if the PLA were not following protocols, neither would we, and that I would not accept a repeat of such incidents.

At Delhi, a flurry of CCS meetings preceded by China Study Group (CSG) meetings followed. The CSG is an informal group steered by the MEA, comprising the Foreign and Defence Ministers, NSA, CDS, Army Chief, Secretaries of the Foreign, Defence and Home Ministries, Secretary R&AW, Director General ITBP and others as required.[14] It is the CSG that, over the years, had been discussing and formulating our long-term strategy with China, including aspects such as patrolling policy, creation of infrastructure, prioritization of road construction, etc. The general sentiment was that we too had to do 'something'. But 'something' doesn't happen overnight. The way that the PLA and the PLAAF had built up clearly showed that this was not some action by some overzealous local commander or even at the level of their Western Theatre Command. That an action such as this was

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